



## Pioneer Certificate Program

☐ **Pre-Statehood:** Direct descendant of an early settler who settled in Michigan prior to Michigan's statehood (prior to January 26, 1837)

☒ **First Families:** Direct descendant of an early settler in a community, settlement, or county of Michigan (January 26, 1837-December 31, 1880)

**Eligibility:** Anyone may apply. Each ancestor in the direct line must be proven with acceptable documentation (see additional instructions). Additional documentation may be requested.

**Fees:** Application fee of \$25 USD (submitted with application) is non-refundable and includes one certificate, a commemorative pin, printing, and postage costs. The certificate will be presented after the application is proofed and accepted. Allow up to 12 weeks for processing.

**Instructions:** Fill out all pages of this form, sign, and submit fees. Include copies of all proof documentation. Do not send originals as items will not be returned. Each fact must have accompanying documentation. This form is electronically fillable (tab through each section).

|                                                                                   |                                                                                                                       |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Early Ancestor (s):                                                               | Marshall L. Pratt                                                                                                     |
| Date & place in Michigan that ancestor settled:                                   | 10 Sept 1838                                                                                                          |
| Proof of settlement:                                                              | Accession Nr: MI1250__479. See attachment                                                                             |
| Ancestor's biographical details (where s/he immigrated from, spouse and children) | Marshall L Pratt was born in Massachuettis and died in Nebraska. In his life journey he also homesteaded in Michigan. |

**Permission Release:** I am a direct descendant of the ancestor named in this application. The information is accurate to the best of my knowledge, and agree to follow the format requested. I acknowledge that all material submitted become the property of Michigan Genealogical Council (MGC), and I hereby give permission to the MGC to include and/or reproduce the following submitted application and sources, not readily available, to researchers. Do not send originals.

|                           |                                         |       |              |
|---------------------------|-----------------------------------------|-------|--------------|
| Applicant's Printed Name: | David J. Kenner                         |       |              |
| Address:                  | 14815 Michele Drive, Glenelg, MD. 21737 |       |              |
| Email:                    | davidjkenner@gmail.com                  | Phone | 240-474-2998 |
| Applicant's Signature     |                                         |       | Today's Date |

Mail completed application, all documentation, and fee payable to "Michigan Genealogical Council" to:

Michigan Genealogical Council  
Attn: Certificates  
P.O. Box 80953  
Lansing, MI 48908-0953

|                                   |                          |
|-----------------------------------|--------------------------|
| <b>FOR MGC USE ONLY</b>           | Date Approved:           |
|                                   | Approved By:             |
| Date Received:                    | Certificate #:           |
| Fee Paid <input type="checkbox"/> | Date Certificate Mailed: |

**Application Instructions:** Please print legibly or type in black ink. Do not use staples to fasten proofs to forms.

1. Please completely fill out one application for each certificate.
2. Complete the Direct Lineage Chart. Each person, including applicant, must be proved as the child of preceding generation.
3. Names:
  - a. Use all capitals for surnames.
  - b. Use maiden names for all women listed.
  - c. List all given names of an individual
  - d. Use quotation marks around nicknames
4. Dates and Places:
  - a. Write dates as day / month / year Example: [01/Jan/1880]
  - b. Write places as Town or Township, County, State or Country
  - c. Use postal abbreviations for state names
5. Verifying proof must be submitted for each fact: birth, marriage, death, etc.
6. Do NOT send original documents. Send only copies of proof documents. Nothing will be returned.
7. Number the proof documents for each generation consecutively. Documents may be used for more than one generation
8. The following items should be included on the back of each proof document submitted:
  - a. Applicant's name and Ancestor's name
  - b. Identify Generation and document number (example: Gen. 2 Doc #3; Gen 2/3 Doc #3)
9. Cite the sources for all proof documents on form. Make sure you have recorded the corresponding reference number.
10. Photocopies of original documents are preferred proof documents, if available. Secondary sources are accepted when properly sourced and used with available primary sources. Copies of photos may be submitted if properly identified. **Photos cannot be returned.** Examples of proof documents include, but are not limited to, those listed in the table below.
11. All materials submitted become the property of the Michigan Genealogical Council. Only approved applications will be filed at the Archives of Michigan for availability to future researchers. Sources or documents, not readily available, will be scanned and available to researchers upon request to this committee. (Excluding documents of those still living)
12. The committee shall determine eligibility and their decision shall be considered final.
13. Any questions may be directed to [certificates@mimgc.org](mailto:certificates@mimgc.org) Mail completed application & all documents with check or money order payable to: Michigan Genealogical Council

Attn: Certificates

P.O. Box 80953

Lansing, MI 48908-0953

**Acceptable Proof Documents:**

|                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|---------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Vital Records                         | Birth, Marriage, Death                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| Church Records                        | Birth, Baptism/Christening, Marriage, Death or Burial                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| Bible Records                         | Must include copy of Bible publication page. Date entry should be contemporary with the publication or printing date of the Bible.                                                                                                        |
| Military Records                      | Enlistment, service, discharge or pension papers                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| Census Records                        | State or Federal. Must include a copy of the headings with the location information                                                                                                                                                       |
| Cemetery or Sexton Records            | Must include name and location of cemetery. May include memorial number, Section and Lot number if known. Photos of headstones or markers only if information on stone is legible in the photo. Unsourced biographies are not acceptable. |
| Government Records                    | Immigration, Naturalization, Passports, Land & Deeds, Probate records, Tax records, Voter lists, or Lawsuits.                                                                                                                             |
| Newspapers                            | Obituaries & articles must be dated. Name of paper and publication information must be included (place published; date; page number, etc.)                                                                                                |
| City /County Directories              | Must include publication information                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| County Histories<br>(Contemporaneous) | Include a photocopy of title page and publication information                                                                                                                                                                             |
| Family Histories<br>(Contemporaneous) | Include a photocopy of title page and publication information                                                                                                                                                                             |
| Plat & Survey Maps                    | Include publication information when known                                                                                                                                                                                                |

# Michigan Genealogical Council Pioneer Certificate Program

## Additional Application Instructions

The Pioneer Certificate Program is a direct descendant project. Lineage through adoption is not accepted.

Please read the application packet along with these additional instructions before preparing your submission. This committee will not be responsible for the research needed to complete the application. Questions about the application or possible resources are welcome. However, volunteers from societies belonging to the council may be able to help with the preparation of the application.

Each generation will need to be documented using reliable evidence, as in primary and secondary sources. This committee will determine the acceptability of all documents submitted to verify lineage. The Pioneer Committee will have the final say in its approval.

Ancestors in the same direct lineal descent (meaning direct bloodline) may be eligible for both certificates. For example, the father or mother of your First Families submission may qualify for Pre-Statehood. It is acceptable to combine the two applications using one set of documentation, checking the appropriate boxes on the application **AND INCLUDING TWO APPLICATION FEES**. This (using one set of documents) may only be done at the time of the initial application submission. Certificates will be generated for each qualifying ancestor and appropriate pins awarded.

Additional family members may also wish to apply for a Pioneer Certificate. If, for instance, your child(ren) or sibling(s) wish to submit an application, it **MUST BE INCLUDED IN THE INITIAL PACKET** in order to use one set of documents. An application fee is required for each person applying.

1. Include additional fees
2. Fill out page one of application for each person
3. Fill out and include the generational links page with the appropriate citation page

Connecting to a previously submitted application (this applies only to the current Pioneer Certificate Program established in 2019- not previous programs)

1. The lineage page must be filled out in its entirety.
2. Documents must be submitted linking the new application with the previously accepted application.
3. The citation page must list the new documents, however **ONLY** the Pioneer Certificate Number needs to be listed for the generations already proven.

### PAGE 1

Please fill out the Early Ancestor's name as you wish it to appear on the certificate- this includes the names of a couple, if application is for both.

The same applies to the applicant's printed name- fill this out as you wish it to appear on the certificate.

Understand that you are giving permission to share your application and your sources. The application will be housed at the Archive of Michigan. Your documents will be scanned and available, through this committee, for future researchers. NOTE: this committee will use a 100 year rule (current standard for Michigan) for sharing current birth records, however the citation will be available. For example, if you send your birth certificate the citations only will be available: BC, Michigan BC. Michigan does not restrict death and marriage records.

It would not be unusual for you to receive a request for additional documentation. Reviewing the application for completeness and perhaps working with a local genealogical society might alleviate that occurrence.

Please do not use highlighter and do not staple documents together.

Documents must be legible. Provide transcriptions for any hard to read documents or those recorded in languages other than English.

### **Form for Generations:**

Fill out names as instructed on application.

Make sure you also cite and send a copy of the documentation used to prove residency.

Document #/Reference column:

1. Use abbreviation for document type (such as BC or BR-see list of abbreviations)
2. Each document needs to have a corresponding Reference number, simply number each document and then use that number for the citation page.
3. REMEMBER some documents may be used for more than one fact. Example: a death certificate may be used for the date of birth, birth location, death date and death location.

LINK BETWEEN GENERATIONS: list the document used for the link with the reference number.

Example: BC #1

Source Citation Page (s)

1. Please use as complete a citation format as possible, this will ensure a future research will be able to duplicate your research.

### **Examples**

Books: use Author, title, volume, page, publisher, publication date, where found

Census:

1880 C, Oakland Co, MI, p, #

Newspaper:

Obit, Pontiac Press, date, p#, col #

Cemetery:

TS (tombstone) FindAGrave.com, Memorial # 123456 (only copies of readable stones are accepted, non-documented biographical information is not acceptable. In some cases acceptable documents, such as death certificates have been uploaded to the page but a citation must be included)

Bur Rec, Elmwood Cemetery, Detroit, Wayne Co., MI

Published transcriptions would follow book format

Church records: US Dutch Reformed Church Rec in selected states, 1639-1989, NY Germantown NY, book 81, Ancestry.com,

Bible: John Jones Family Bible, in possession of applicant (or state where found)

Town Records: Town Rec, Cumberland, ME, BK 1, p 36

Webpages: Title, URL, date accessed

Will: Essex Co, MS, WB 4, pgs 49-56

Online databases: Ancestry.com

### **Common Abbreviations**

a- Ante/Before

p- After/Post

bur- Buried

bapt- Baptized

BC/DC/MC-birth certificate, death certificate, marriage certificate

BR/DR/MR-birth record, death record, marriage record

Twp-Township

Co-County

GENERATION 1 is the name of the applicant. In all other generations, list the man's name first. Capitalize all LAST names. The name of the spouse must be documented as well as the direct line ancestors. Add dates and location. List document or type of source included in application (Ex: Birth Certificate is (BC). Add the number used as reference for EACH LINK (Ex: BC #1; DC #2)

BETWEEN GENERATIONS: include the type of document or source used to link between two generations. If filling out electronically, click in box to fill, TAB to next box.

| GEN                              | Name                    |                                   | Event Date/Location          | Document #/Reference |
|----------------------------------|-------------------------|-----------------------------------|------------------------------|----------------------|
| 1                                | David J. KENNER         | born                              | Living                       | 1                    |
|                                  |                         | loc                               | Living                       |                      |
| spouse                           |                         | born                              |                              |                      |
|                                  |                         | loc                               |                              |                      |
|                                  | Married                 | date                              |                              |                      |
|                                  |                         | loc                               |                              |                      |
|                                  |                         | died                              |                              |                      |
|                                  |                         | loc                               |                              |                      |
| 1/2 LINK BETWEEN GENERATION USED |                         |                                   |                              |                      |
| The said                         |                         | Is the biological son/daughter of |                              | Document #/Reference |
| 2                                | Jerome KENNER           | born                              | 22 Apr 1933                  | 1                    |
|                                  |                         | loc                               | Doniphan, Ripley, MO.        | 1                    |
|                                  |                         | died                              | 21 Feb 2020                  | 1                    |
|                                  |                         | loc                               | Campbell, Dunklin, MO.       | 1                    |
| spouse                           | Marie BOWER             | born                              | 8 Aug 1936                   | 1                    |
|                                  |                         | loc                               | Poplar Bluff, Butler, MO.    | 1                    |
|                                  | Married                 | date                              | Living                       |                      |
|                                  |                         | loc                               | Living                       |                      |
|                                  |                         | died                              | Living                       |                      |
|                                  |                         | loc                               | Living                       |                      |
| 2/3 LINK BETWEEN GENERATION USED |                         |                                   |                              |                      |
| The said                         |                         | Is the biological son/daughter of |                              | Document #/Reference |
| 3                                | Oscar Lee BOWER         | born                              | 28 Feb 1910                  | 1                    |
|                                  |                         | loc                               | Chillicothe, Livingston, MO. | 1                    |
|                                  |                         | died                              |                              |                      |
|                                  |                         | loc                               |                              |                      |
| spouse                           | Roberta HOLMAN          | born                              | 30 Aug 1913                  | 1                    |
|                                  |                         | loc                               | Oklahoma                     | 1                    |
|                                  | Married                 | date                              | before 16 Oct 1940           | 1                    |
|                                  |                         | loc                               | unknown                      |                      |
|                                  |                         | died                              | 10 Nov 2012                  | 1                    |
|                                  |                         | loc                               | Harviell, Butler, MO.        | 1                    |
| 3/4 LINK BETWEEN GENERATION USED |                         |                                   |                              |                      |
| The said                         |                         | Is the biological son/daughter of |                              | Document #/Reference |
| 4                                | Robert James HOLMAN III | born                              | 25 Jan 1860                  | 1                    |
|                                  |                         | loc                               | Oxford, Oakland, Michigan    | 1                    |
|                                  |                         | died                              | 5 Jan 1946                   | 1                    |
|                                  |                         | loc                               | Vidor, Orange, TX.           | 1                    |
| spouse                           | Evalyn Gray OLDBURY     | born                              | 1870                         | 1                    |
|                                  |                         | loc                               | Nebraska                     | 1                    |
|                                  | Married                 | date                              | 13 Mar 1911                  | 1                    |
|                                  |                         | loc                               | Harper, Oklahoma, USA        | 1                    |
|                                  |                         | died                              | 10 Feb 1965                  | 2                    |
|                                  |                         | loc                               | Vidor, Orange, Texas         | 2                    |

|                                  |                   |                                   |                   |                      |
|----------------------------------|-------------------|-----------------------------------|-------------------|----------------------|
| 4/5 LINK BETWEEN GENERATION USED |                   |                                   |                   |                      |
| The said                         | Evalyn GRAY       | Is the biological son/daughter of |                   | Document #/Reference |
| 5                                | Robert GRAY       | born                              | 1832              | 2                    |
|                                  |                   | loc                               | Maine             | 5                    |
|                                  |                   | died                              | 1903              | 4                    |
|                                  |                   | loc                               | Nebraska          | 4                    |
| spouse                           | Isabell PRATT     | born                              | 1846              | 2, 3,5               |
|                                  |                   | loc                               | Illinois          | 3                    |
|                                  | Married           | date                              | before 1869       | 4,5                  |
|                                  |                   | loc                               | probably Nebraska | 4, 5                 |
|                                  |                   | died                              | 1917              | 4                    |
|                                  |                   | loc                               | Nebraska          | 4                    |
| 5/6 LINK BETWEEN GENERATION USED |                   |                                   |                   |                      |
| The said                         | Isabell PRATT     | Is the biological son/daughter of |                   | Document #/Reference |
| 6                                | Marshall L. Pratt | born                              | 1811              | 3                    |
|                                  |                   | loc                               | Massachusetts     | 3                    |
|                                  |                   | died                              | 1879              | 6                    |
|                                  |                   | loc                               | Nebraska          | 6                    |
| spouse                           | Fredricka Pratt   | born                              | 1820              | 3                    |
|                                  |                   | loc                               | Germany           | 3                    |
|                                  | Married           | date                              | before 1841       | 3                    |
|                                  |                   | loc                               | Probably Illinois | 3                    |
|                                  |                   | died                              |                   |                      |
|                                  |                   | loc                               |                   |                      |
| 6/7 LINK BETWEEN GENERATION USED |                   |                                   |                   |                      |
| The said                         |                   | Is the biological son/daughter of |                   | Document #/Reference |
| 7                                |                   | born                              |                   |                      |
|                                  |                   | loc                               |                   |                      |
|                                  |                   | died                              |                   |                      |
|                                  |                   | loc                               |                   |                      |
| spouse                           |                   | born                              |                   |                      |
|                                  |                   | loc                               |                   |                      |
|                                  | Married           | date                              |                   |                      |
|                                  |                   | loc                               |                   |                      |
|                                  |                   | died                              |                   |                      |
|                                  |                   | loc                               |                   |                      |
| 7/8 LINK BETWEEN GENERATION USED |                   |                                   |                   |                      |
| The said                         |                   | Is the biological son/daughter of |                   | Document #/Reference |
| 8                                |                   | born                              |                   |                      |
|                                  |                   | loc                               |                   |                      |
|                                  |                   | died                              |                   |                      |
|                                  |                   | loc                               |                   |                      |
| spouse                           |                   | born                              |                   |                      |
|                                  |                   | loc                               |                   |                      |
|                                  | Married           | date                              |                   |                      |
|                                  |                   | loc                               |                   |                      |
|                                  |                   | died                              |                   |                      |
|                                  |                   | loc                               |                   |                      |

|                                   |         |                                   |                      |
|-----------------------------------|---------|-----------------------------------|----------------------|
| 8/9 LINK BETWEEN GENERATION USED  |         |                                   |                      |
| The said                          |         | Is the biological son/daughter of | Document #/Reference |
| 9                                 |         | born                              |                      |
|                                   |         | loc                               |                      |
|                                   |         | died                              |                      |
|                                   |         | loc                               |                      |
| spouse                            |         | born                              |                      |
|                                   |         | loc                               |                      |
|                                   | Married | date                              |                      |
|                                   |         | loc                               |                      |
|                                   |         | died                              |                      |
|                                   |         | loc                               |                      |
| 9/10 LINK BETWEEN GENERATION USED |         |                                   |                      |
| The said                          |         | Is the biological son/daughter of | Document #/Reference |
| 10                                |         | born                              |                      |
|                                   |         | loc                               |                      |
|                                   |         | died                              |                      |
|                                   |         | loc                               |                      |
| spouse                            |         | born                              |                      |
|                                   |         | loc                               |                      |
|                                   | Married | date                              |                      |
|                                   |         | loc                               |                      |
|                                   |         | died                              |                      |
|                                   |         | loc                               |                      |

This form is fillable. Use next page as necessary.

|                 |                                                                                                                                            |
|-----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Document Number | Source Citation. Please use complete format, author, title, volume, page, publisher, publication date, and location where source was found |
| 1               | Hannah Parker Michigan First Families Certificate #F-027                                                                                   |
| 2               | Evalyn Gray Death Certificate. TX 11259                                                                                                    |
| 3               | US Census 1850; Census Place: Highland, Iowa, Wisconsin; Roll: M432_999; Page: 368A; Image: 343                                            |
| 4               | Isabell Pratt Tombstone. FindAGrave Memorial 79992854                                                                                      |
| 5               | US Census 1880; Census Place: Weeping Water, Cass, Nebraska; Roll: 744; Page: 255D; Enumeration District: 269                              |
| 6               | Marshall L. Pratt Tombstone. FindAGrave Memorial 97483970                                                                                  |
| 7               |                                                                                                                                            |
| 8               |                                                                                                                                            |
|                 |                                                                                                                                            |
|                 |                                                                                                                                            |
|                 |                                                                                                                                            |

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